1831. HMS Beagle sets sail on a circumnavigation of the world, with Charles Darwin serving as the voyage’s naturalist. The trip provides Darwin with the information that inspired his theory of evolution by natural selection.

1866. Gregor Mendel’s paper “Experiments with Plant Hybrids” outlines findings from his pea plant experiments, laying the foundations for the field of genetics.

1953. In The Eagle pub in Cambridge, UK, Francis Crick and James Watson announce that they have discovered the structure of DNA.

1976. The Selfish Gene by evolutionary biologist Richard Dawkins offers a new perspective on evolution, looking at the gene, as opposed to the species or group.

2003. The Human Genome Project produces the first genetic blueprint of Homo sapiens.

2010. Scientists around the world are working on projects such as The i5k Initiative, Earth